

Block 2 — Life Span: School Years (6–11) · Cognitive · Social · Moral · Special Topics

Piaget: Concrete Operations **10M**

5-to-7 Shift

Pre-operational → rudimentary logic. **Cross-modal zones** well developed ages 5–6.

Key Operations

Decentration: consider several aspects simultaneously. **Conservation** sequence: number (6–7) → mass/length (7–8) → weight (9–10) → volume (14–15). **Horizontal décalage** (Inhelder & Piaget, 1955/58).

Three enabling concepts: **Identity** · **Reversibility** · **Reciprocity**.

Concept Formation

Number: one-to-one correspondence by 6–7. Time: difficulty until 8. Spatial: cognitive maps slow. Class inclusion by 6–7. Seriation.

Logical Reasoning

Inductive reasoning (specific→general). Deductive logic appears at formal operations. **Three Mountain Task** solved by 11–12.

Information Processing **10M**

Attention: improves; interest = high getter. **Perception:** Embedded Figures Test (Witkin et al., 1971). **Memory:** rehearsal, **elaboration**, categorisation, **metamemory**.

4 mechanisms (Block 3): Encoding · Strategy construction · Automatisation · Generalisation. + Self-modification · Task analysis.

Kohlberg's Moral Development **10M**

Three Levels, Six Stages

Level	Stage	Orientation
Preconventional	1	Punishment-obedience
	2	Instrumental-exchange
Conventional	3	Good-boy-nice-girl
	4	System-maintaining (law & order)
Postconventional	5	Social-contract
	6	Universal ethical principles

Heinz dilemma (Kohlberg & Gilligan, 1971). Analysed **reasons**, not answers.

Piaget: Heteronomous morality (6–7; imminent justice, objective consequences, absolutism) → Autonomous morality (~10; cooperation). Hartshorne & May (1928–30): moral standards ≠ moral behaviour.

Language Development **6M**

Ages 6–12: vocab expansion. 6–7: confused by complex constructions. Language difficulties → aggressive behaviour (Burke et al., 1989). Communication effectiveness develops.

Grammar & Semantics **3M**

Refine language structure. Word relationships. Sensitivity to beauty of language. Literature = training memory + sensitivity.

Motor Development **6M**

Gross (large muscles) learnt **before** fine (small muscles). **Sensitive period**.

Handwriting improves 6–11. Girls > boys dexterity. Eye-hand coordination improves. **6 basic behaviours:** running, jumping, sequencing, balancing, throwing, catching.

Secular trend = children today taller, mature earlier.

Emotional Patterns **3M**

Fear (typical→general) · Anxiety (increases 4th–6th grade) · Anger (impulsive vs. inhibited) · Curiosity ("questioning age") · Joy. **Emotional tolerance**.

Factors: health, intellect, environment, social reactions. SES: low SES = more fears.

Social Development **10M**

Parents → **consultants**. Mothers preferred; fathers encourage independence. Household responsibilities → mature behaviour (Baumrind, 1971).

Siblings: teach/help; practice social skills. **Peers:** gender segregation (6–9) → crowds/cliques (9–12). Conformity peak grades 8–9.

Popularity: sociable, cooperative. Rejected: aggressive/withdrawn. Neglected: neither liked/disliked.

Self-Esteem **6M**

William James (1892): self-worth = actual vs. ideal. Five areas: scholastic, athletic, appearance, social, morality.

Parental influence: supportive → high esteem; belittling → low esteem (Grolnick & Ryan, 1989).

Height & Weight Factors **3M**

7 factors (Hurlock, 1978): Family · Nutrition · Emotional (adrenal steroids) · SES · Health · Endocrine · Sex.

Growth: 5–6 cm/year. Body types: endomorphic, mesomorphic, ectomorphic.

Learning to Write **3M**

Handwriting improves 6–11. Eye-hand: age 8 = planning; age 10 = speed/direction (Bairstow, 1989). Girls greater dexterity.

Learning Disability **6M**

Disorder in basic psychological processes. Average-to-superior intelligence. Types: **dyslexia** (reading), **dysgraphia** (writing), **dyscalculia** (math).

Identification: IQ-achievement discrepancy. Remedial: **IEP**, multisensory instruction, assistive technology.

Intellectual Disability **6M**

Subaverage IQ + deficits in adaptive behaviour + before age 18. Levels: Mild (50–70) · Moderate (35–50) · Severe (20–35) · Profound (<20).

Causes: genetic (Down syndrome), prenatal, perinatal, postnatal. Remedial: early intervention, life skills, inclusive education.

Exceptional Children **3M**

Deviates from normal; requires specialised services. Positive (gifted) or negative (disabilities). Approaches: inclusive education, IEP, resource rooms.

Value Education **6M**

Develop moral reasoning, empathy, character. Methods: storytelling, role-playing, group discussions, community service.

Educational excursions: experiential learning, real-world connections, motivation.